



POLICE OFFICER

JOB DESCRIPTION

Police officers maintain law and order on a local and national level. In this role, you may conduct patrols to reassure the public and deter criminal activity, work with community groups to promote lawful behavior, respond to calls from the public for assistance, catch and testify against offenders, and investigate crimes by gathering evidence and questioning suspects and witnesses.



SALARY

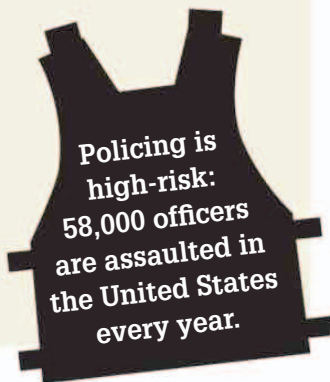
Trainee police officer ★★★★★
Senior police officer ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

A varied, diverse, and expanding profession • Strong competition for entry-level jobs • Opportunities for promotion and career development are good

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **PROBATION OFFICER** *see pp. 244–245*
- ▶ **BODYGUARD** Accompanies individuals or groups of people and takes any necessary action to protect them from harmful or violent situations. Bodyguards are usually hired by important public figures, such as government officials.
- ▶ **CUSTOMS OFFICER** Monitors, investigates, and prevents illegal trade across international borders. Activities include intelligence gathering, cooperating with international agencies, and inspecting suspicious cargo at ports and airports.
- ▶ **SECURITY OFFICER**
Uses closed-circuit television and in-store observation of shoppers and staff to prevent shoplifting or damage to property in retail stores and shopping malls.



AT A GLANCE



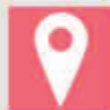
YOUR INTERESTS Law enforcement • Criminal law • Psychology • Sociology • Physical Education (PE) • English • Mathematics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Entry requirements vary, but potential officers must pass stringent aptitude and fitness tests as well as background checks.



LIFESTYLE Official working hours are regular, but shiftwork to cover evenings, weekends, and public holidays may be required. Overtime is available.



LOCATION Work is in a wide range of settings, from investigating crime scenes to desk work at a police station or testifying in a court of law.



THE REALITIES Police officers get excellent benefits, but they encounter high-risk situations and work long hours. Serving a community is rewarding.